Notes 3

Graphical User Interface (GUI)

A set of programs that lets the user interact with the computer through icons, windows, and other visual elements.

Desktop Environment

A bundle of programs running on top of the operating system that shares a common GUI; it can be thought of as a graphical shell. Linux distributions can come with different desktop environments, with GNOME and KDE being common examples.

Command Line Interface (CLI)

Allows you to interact with a computer by typing commands into a terminal instead of using graphical menus and buttons.

How do I access the command line interface (CLI)?

In Linux, you can access the CLI by taking the system out of graphical desktop mode and place it in text mode.

Virtual Console

A terminal session that runs in Linux system memory.

Terminal Emulator

A program that allows you to access the Linux CLI when using the GUI.

Bash

A program that provides interactive access to the Linux system.

Shell Prompt

The shell prompt shows that the terminal is ready for you to enter a command.

Definitions, Usage, Examples

clear

- Definition: Clears the terminal screen
- Usage: clear
- Example: clear

echo

- Definition: Displays text or a message in the terminal.
- Usage: echo "Hello World"
- Example: echo "Hello World"

date

- Definition: Displays the current date and time.
- Usage: date
- Example: date

free

- Definition: Displays information about the computer's memory usage.
- Usage: free
- Example: free -h

uname

- Definition: Displays information about the operating system and computer.
- Usage: uname [option]
- Example: uname -a

history

- Definition: Displays a list of commands that were previously entered in the terminal.
- Usage: history
- Example: history

man

- Definition: Displays the manual page for a command.
- Usage: man [command]
- Example: man ls

tldr

- Definition: Gives a simple summary and examples of a command.
- Usage: tldr [command]
- Example: tldr ls

cheat

- Definition: Provides quick reference information for a command.
- Usage: cheat [command]
- Example: cheat ls

hostname

- Definition: Displays the name of the computer on the network.
- Usage: hostname
- Example: hostname

df

- Definition: Displays the amount of disk space available and used on the computer.
- Usage: df [option]
- Example: df -h

du

- Definition: Displays the amount of disk space used by files and directories.
- Usage: du [option] [file or directory]
- Example: du -h

figlet

- Definition: Displays text in large ASCII-style letters in the terminal.
- Usage: figlet [text]
- Example: figlet Hello